

WannaCry 101

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WannaCry is one of the biggest malware attacks the world has witnessed recently. Infrastructure services, banks, telecom companies, airports, and hospitals across 99 countries and 200,000 computer systems have been affected by this massive cyber attack.

At least two new strains of the malware infection that exploits vulnerabili-

Experts believe the malware takes advantage of a vulnerability in Windows PCs that was identified by the United States' National Security Agency (NSA). Details of an NSA tool named 'EternalBlue' were leaked by a hacking group called Shadow Brokers back in April. This tool apparently enabled hackers to add the worm feature to the WannaCry ransomware, giving it the ability to

spread across systems. Although Microsoft patched the flaw back in March, many users, and organisational IT departments did not update their systems, making them open to the attack.

Was India hit by WannaCry?

India was indeed affected by WannaCry. However, an official statement by the Computer Emergency

Response Team (CERT), said that "very few reports come from our country." The response team has also released a list of file extensions that are being affected by WannaCry, which include - .der, .pdf, .key, .xls, .dot, .psd, .moc, .mp3, and many more. Once infected, these files are encrypted with the extension .WCRY .

ties in older Windows software such as XP and Windows Server 2003, have been found since the attack was initiated on Friday. As office-goers retired for the weekend, WannaCry hit organisations such as the National Health Services (NHS) in England and Scotland. As per a BBC report, Russia has seen the most number of infected computer systems. Spain's telecom behemoth Telefonica and utilities firms - Iberdrola and Gas Natural were also hit by WannaCry. In addition to the above, worldwide shipping service FedEx has also reported being hit by WannaCry.

How was it initiated, and by whom?

WannaCry is a ransomware that is quick to spread once any computer in an organisation is affected. Once infected, the WannaCry program then encrypts files on the computer, blocking users from accessing critical information and asking for a payment of \$300 to \$600 in Bitcoins to unlock files on each affected computer.

How to save yourself from WannaCry?

MalwareTech registered a URL query which was built into WannaCry, thereby slowing its advance. However, CERT has given out a set of preventive measures one can take to stay safe.

For starters, users are advised to patch their Windows systems as mentioned in Microsoft's Security Bulletin MS17-010. Microsoft has also issued a patch for unsupported versions such as Windows XP, Vista, Server 2003 and Server 2008.

Further, organisations and individuals are also advised to take a backup of critical files and store them offline.

To read more: <http://digit.in/WCry101>

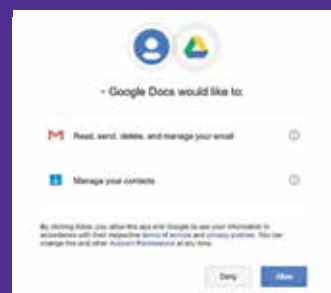
Google Docs phishing scam

A

widespread phishing scam hit Google Docs users, making their Gmail

accounts and contact lists vulnerable to hackers. A phishing attack usually entails attackers trying to retrieve personal information from users through unscrupulous emails disguised as important messages. However, this is not what happened with the Google Docs phishing scam.

The attackers used a more sophisticated approach, creating a non-Google web app impersonating Google Docs. They then sent out emails to Gmail users, which appeared to have



been sent by a known contact asking them to edit a Google Docs document. Those who clicked on the Google Docs phishing link were redirected to a real Google sign-in screen for a third party app and asked to "continue to Docs." This fooled users into granting access and permissions to the malicious web app without knowing the risk.

Google does not normally ask users for such permissions, especially for Google Docs. If you happened to have received such an email recently, you'd better change all your passwords ASAP and warn people in your contacts list. This is because the attacker sent similar spam emails to the contacts of users who clicked on the phishing link.

Fortunately, Google has managed to fix the issue almost immediately. There was no exact info about the number of accounts compromised, but reports indicate that it was a massive attack, going up to 0.1% of all Google accounts.